



mortal's Banality has lashed out against a detected source of Glamour — the changeling gains a point of Banality. In order to lower the mortal's Banality, a sufficiently large change of life circumstances is required, since most mortals with high Banality ratings have a particular feature of their life that generates it. The changeling must convince the mortal to quit that job, to let go of bitter feelings from that divorce, and so on. The Storyteller should select such a task, though the cause of a mortal's Banality is typically quite straightforward.

⑤ When Mira's life becomes too set, she becomes a wilder and, flooded with a need to travel and act, does something she never thought she would — she goes home. Her father is not best pleased to see her. Bitter and angry after a failed marriage, and with a daughter who didn't live up to his expectations, he threw Mira out before she even finished high school, and the two have not spoken since. Mira finds his mind so clouded with bigotry and Banality that she can scarcely stand to share a room with him at first, but when she swears to drag him out of this rut or die trying, something in her changes. Being with him is still miserable, but it's no longer dangerous in quite the same way, even if their arguments come to shouting more often than not. When she finds a twice-overdue bill in the mail and multiple collections notices, Mira realizes the original stressor that led to her father's downward spiral. His zero-hour part-time contract at the local Big Box has no hope of ever repaying his debts, and he's on the verge of losing his house. A clever wager and some time with his old metalworking tools later, however, and he's made more in a day selling handcrafted scrap-metal jewelry at a farmer's market than he would have in weeks at Big Box. It's the work of years, but he slowly comes out of his Banality-encrusted shell, drawn by the lure of financial stability until, without realizing it, he's creating art for its own sake. He may not be perfect; he's still a sour old grouch who'd rather his daughter settle down with a man instead of that harpy from the big city, but for the first time in Mira's life he isn't saying it to her face.

⑤ Ash never wanted anything more than a carefree life, and maybe a few convenient saps on whom to play (harmless, he swears) tricks. More than once he nearly fell to Bedlam, eschewing the mortal world's Banality so violently that it nearly cost him everything. His motley makes sure to enforce a strict time-with-mortals rule. Having spent so long in freeholds and the Dreaming, however, the world has moved on without him! His best friend, Nolan, has 20 years on Ash, and has long since forgotten the fun they had playing Burn Legend in the arcade together — so when Ash tracks him down and shows up at the door of his apartment with a plastic sandwich bag full of quarters in his hand, Nolan nearly faints dead away. Ash finds his friend in sorry shape, laboring away at a monotonous job that demands 60 hours a week at the minimum, and so he takes things seriously for the first time in his life, swearing to drag Nolan out of this well of Banality. Figuring out how takes longer than he thought it would, however, and once Nolan acclimates to the fact that his childhood friend is both alive and still a

child (a story in and of itself, Ash's version of which includes alien abduction and shapeshifting probe ships), they wind up playing Burn Legend EX on his dusty console more than anything else. Rekindling Nolan's passion for fighting games was a complete accident, but was exactly what needed to happen — before long, even without Ash's prodding, he's playing the game in every free moment he has, relearning old reflexes and mastering new systems. When he places in the top eight in a local tournament, he redoubles his efforts, and soon his name is being bandied around the community. Ash can feel the Glamour coming off of him in waves whenever he's competing, stronger every time, and strangely enough he feels better in the mortal world than he has in years in the Dreaming.

⑤ Once, Enoch's prose practically dripped with Glamour, and Adrianna has followed him for many a year, feasting on that Glamour and acting as his muse when needs must — and when someone or something else hasn't caught her eye. Now, having sold the rights to a comic book adaptation, Enoch has moved to a mansion outside of town, ostensibly to provide a cleaner, more focused environment to write in, and has found himself the victim of writer's block so powerful he can scarcely set pen to paper. When Adrianna catches up with him once more, she's shocked — the mansion itself radiates with Banality, the legacy of its former inhabitant, and now that Banality has infected Enoch! The man was her Glamour train as well as her occasional sugar daddy, and she refuses to leave him in such a state — she'd have to find another! Instead, she sets about inspiring Enoch as best she can, and dragging him out of his Banality-tainted home as often as possible — which becomes harder and harder as Enoch becomes increasingly set in his ways. Having forgotten virtually all of the Glamour-fueled wonder Adrianna had shown him in the past, he thinks of her as just another fan, and a particularly annoying one at that. As she lies to him, flattering him and trying to get him to write again, he lies to her, convincing her that he's intimately involved with the writing of the comic adaptation. He tells her it'll all be original, a companion volume to the novels, and this seems to satisfy her until the first issue is released — and is nothing more than a callow, by-the-numbers retread of the novel, with the magic of his prose replaced by dry, unimpressive art. He refuses to answer his door, and after 15 minutes of his phone ringing without answer something shatters inside Adrianna. It might be her heart, but she's too numb to tell.

Nightmare

In addition to the three Temper Traits, players also track a character's Nightmare rating. Nightmare represents the Dreaming pulling the character toward the inhuman madness of the Dreaming; the loss of control and perspective functions as a warning of the changeling's path to Bedlam. Whenever the player rolls the character's Glamour or casts a cantrip, she replaces dice in the pool with Nightmare dice equal to her Nightmare rating, not to exceed the original dice pool.